

You Are AI's Best Friend

From Olives to Algorithms: A Human Guide

Philip Fischer, PhD

with Linda Marie Fischer



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Amid endless AI headlines, enter: Sicilian olive farmers.

A serendipitous meeting at an olive oil mill, with farmers who have adopted automation over generations while staying in charge of it, gave the author a framework for AI: like the farmers' tools, AI should work for humans, never the other way around.

From Sicily to Greece, Cuba, China, and Namibia, readers follow the authors' encounters with a changing world and see what technology gives and takes. The authors drew on the human story by interviewing people, including arborists, business professionals, IT consultants, and scientists, about their firsthand experiences with AI, both good and bad.

“We’re in the early days. AI is becoming ubiquitous but not homogeneous. For most of us, living well in an AI world means using AI well,” Dr. Fischer writes. “This book offers structure for deciding how to use AI, not a manual on tactics. At the heart of the AI era lies the question: What should I do? Ideal readers are curious and uncommitted, not seasoned professionals who’ve already made up their minds... You Are AI’s Best Friend means AI serves you, not the other way around. You choose when and how. Your judgment determines success.”

—Philip Fischer, PhD

Praise

“With clarity and curiosity, Dr Phil Fischer explores the emerging role of AI across multiple industries and cultures. Drawing on his experience as a financial analyst, he brings a grounded, real-world sensibility to a rapidly evolving landscape. His perspective reminds us that understanding AI isn’t just for technologists — it’s for all of us.” — **Leigh Devine. Co-author, Manage Your Stress**

“Dr. Philip Fischer zeroes in on the subject of selectively befriending AI in elegant prose that is both thought-provoking and enjoyable for the reader. Having experienced several historical turning point events throughout his life, Dr. Fischer discusses how to navigate through the ‘technological earthquake’ of AI migration we are amid by offering valuable insights, especially into labor market, education, social and economic trends and poses existential questions that are helpful to today’s society.” — **Mary Dennis Broidy, Former Merrill Lynch FVP Senior Economist, Associate Adjunct Professor, Long Island University**

“In 19 concise chapters Fischer takes readers from the theoretical origins of ‘thinking machines’ through a discussion of today’s AI hopes, fears, challenges and opportunities while offering practical advice for workers, educators, policy makers and informed citizens. This book is a useful addition to any reading list focused on AI and its implications for our future way of life.” — **Jeremy E. Plotnick, PhD, Assistant Professor, Costello College of Business, George Mason University**

Reading Group Guide

Technology

- How does (or doesn't) AI play a role in your life?
- Did the author's emphasis on AI/human connection resonate with you?
- The book presents a variety of perspectives, from experts to casual users.
 - Did any points of view surprise you?
 - Which could you relate to most?
 - Did you feel like there were any voices missing from the book?

Travel

- Was there a time when travel or exposure to another culture prompted you to rethink a belief you already held?
- Have you ever been to any locations mentioned in the book? Which places in the book would you want to visit?
- Are there traditions or rituals in your life that have withstood the test of time, just as the olive farmers have tended their trees for centuries?

About The Authors



Philip Fischer, PhD, has worked across Wall Street, chemical engineering, law, and teaching. A JD with a PhD in finance and a science fiction author, he published novels about AI in 2003 and 2009—long before ChatGPT.



Linda Fischer is a reporter/writer, and business development professional whose work bridges publishing, technology, and entrepreneurship. She is founder and publisher of Minted Prose.

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